CUSTOMER SUCCESS CASE STUDY

Catching Churn Early: A Health Score and Alert System Built in HubSpot

How a B2B SaaS team can spot quietly disengaging customers before they cancel, without reviewing every account by hand.

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Case study project built on a sample data set.

THE CASE

The problem: a customer went quiet and nobody noticed

BukkiBooks is a cloud accounting and invoicing platform for small businesses in Nigeria. One retail account stopped using its inventory reconciliation feature for five weeks, yet its overall activity still looked healthy. A new store manager had never been trained, so the team quietly went back to spreadsheets.

The account was only caught because a CSM happened to notice. That does not scale to thousands of customers.

Who gets attention?

How are at-risk accounts chosen for proactive care?

How does it scale?

Usage data across thousands of customers, not one dashboard.

What does it cost?

High-touch care has to be balanced against serving many accounts.

RESEARCH

What the research showed

Not one market

SMEs are about 96% of Nigerian businesses and 84% of employment, but digital maturity varies widely, so one approach will not fit every account.

Usage predicts churn

A study of 3,959 B2B software subscriptions found usage data improves churn prediction, but it shows what changed, not why.

Track by feature

A total login count would have hidden this problem. Reconciliation fell to zero while invoicing and payments stayed healthy.

MY APPROACH

The process I designed

Monitor > Detect > Assess > Segment > Prioritise > Route > Intervene > Measure

Weekly health score

One 0 to 100 score per account, blending usage breadth, feature depth, support activity and sentiment.

Two automatic alerts

Feature abandonment: a key feature unused for 14 days. Silent freeze: weekly activity down 30% or more against the account's own baseline.

Human diagnosis

Automation detects the change. The CSM finds out why, and decides the response.

MY APPROACH

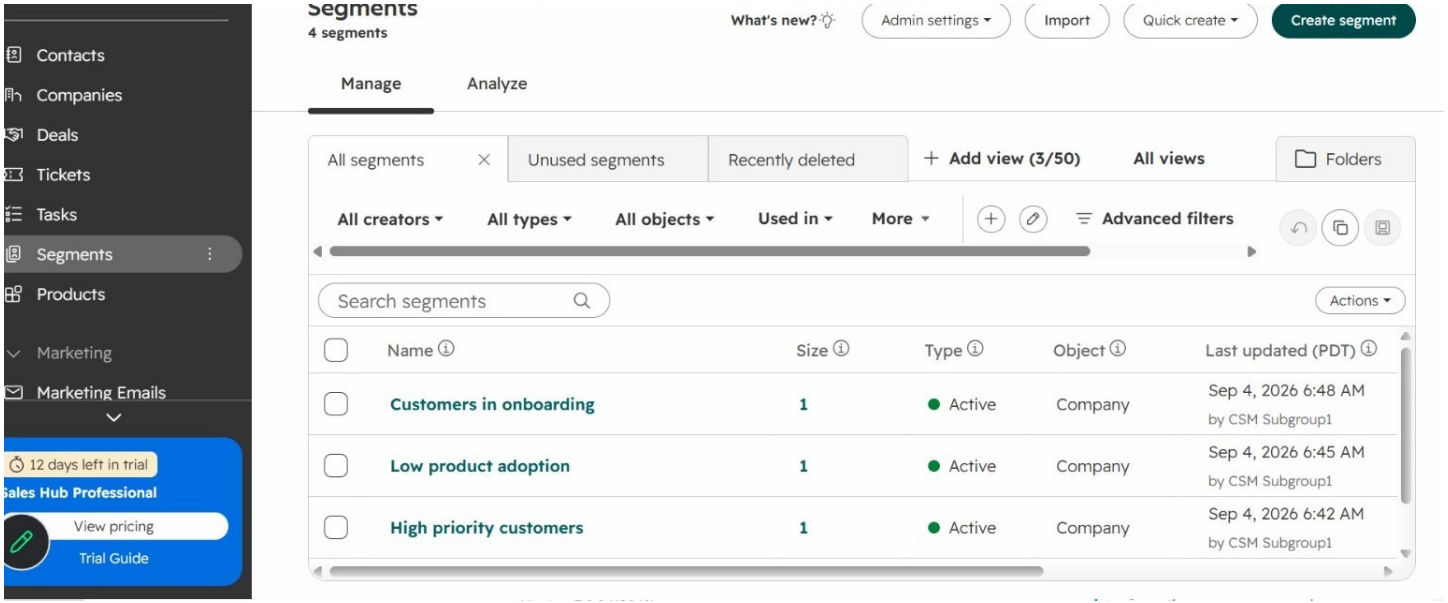
Segments and priority ranking

Segment	What the data shows	Treatment
Healthy, 80 to 100	Stable or rising usage	Automated education only
Needs attention, 50 to 79	Early decline or one feature dropping off	Automated nudge, CSM watches
At risk, below 50	Sharp drop, inactivity or open tickets	CSM outreach and recovery plan
High value and at risk	A large account going quiet	Same-day CSM call

Priority rank = risk severity x account value x renewal date x number of signals firing together. Automation absorbs the low-risk accounts, so CSM hours go only where a conversation can change a renewal.

PROOF OF CONCEPT

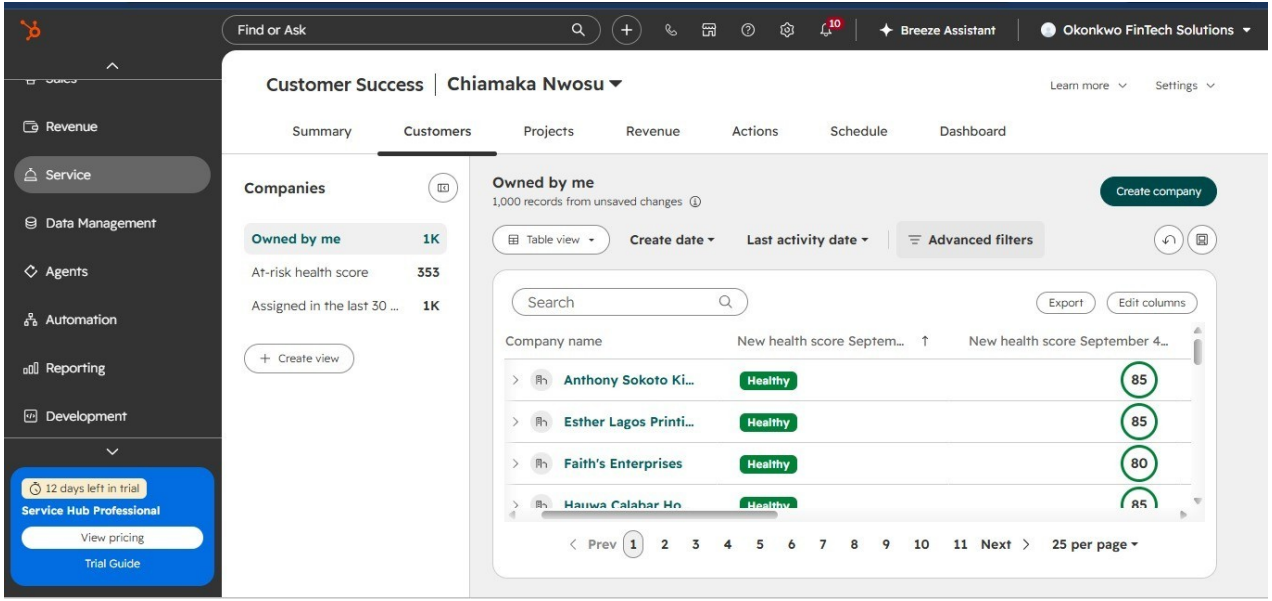
HubSpot build: live segments



Screenshot 1 of 7. Segments are live filters on account data, including customers in onboarding, low product adoption and high priority customers. They update as the data changes, so nobody re-tags accounts by hand.

PROOF OF CONCEPT

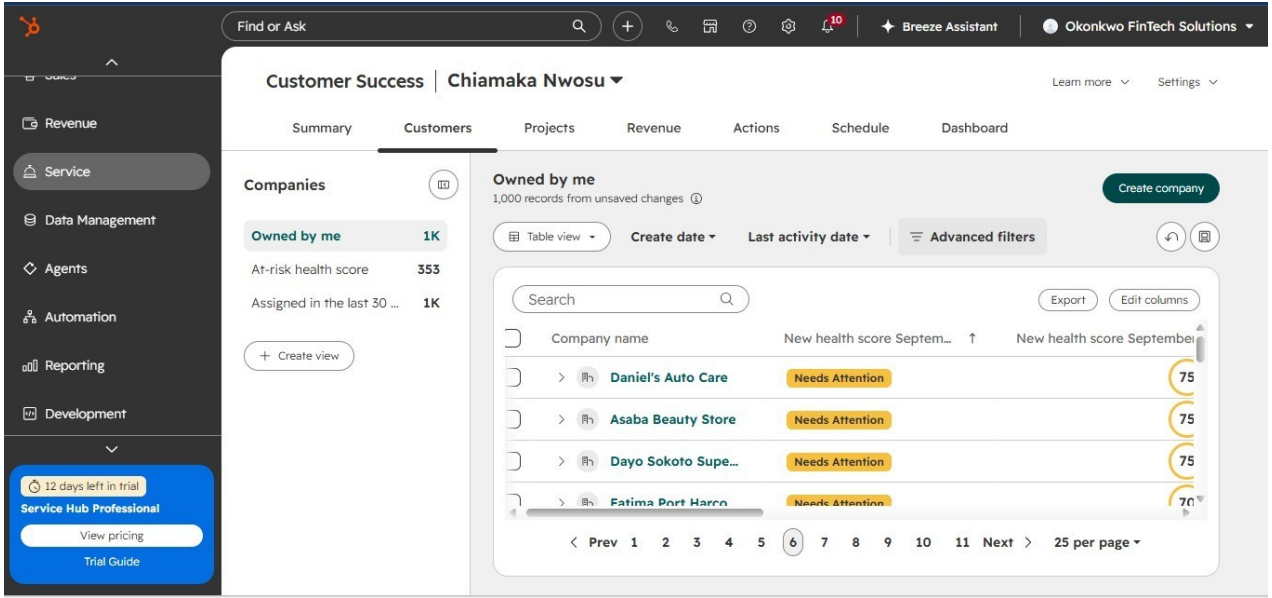
Health scores: healthy accounts



Screenshot 2 of 7. Healthy accounts score 80 to 100. Usage is stable or rising, so they receive automated education and need no CSM time.

PROOF OF CONCEPT

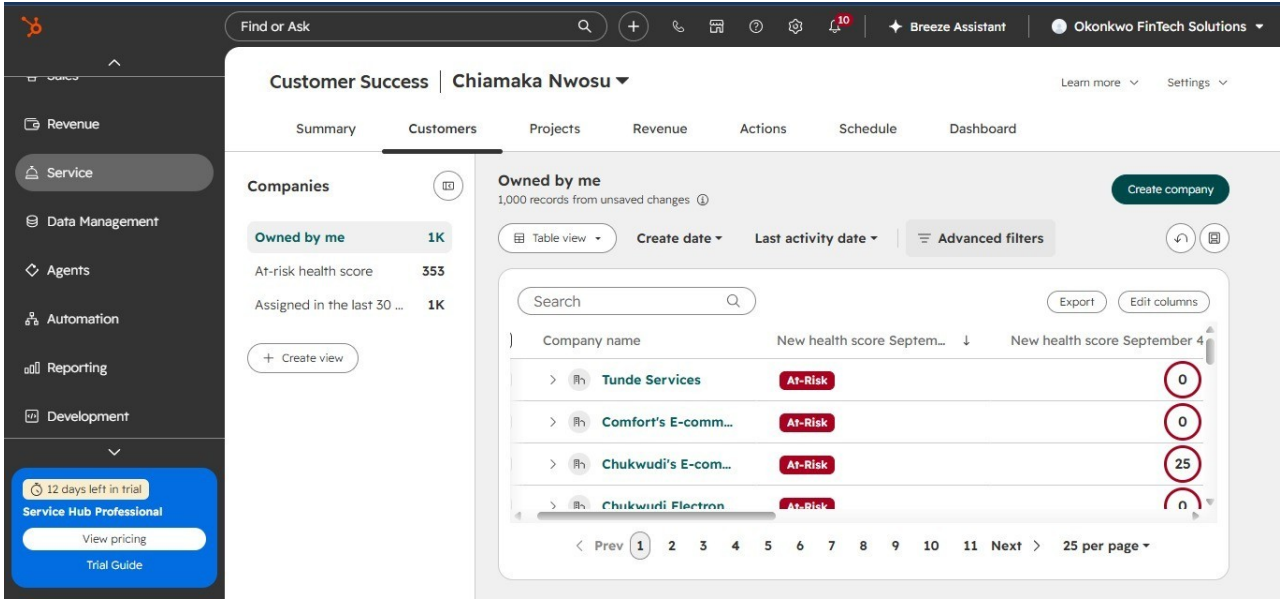
Health scores: needs attention



Screenshot 3 of 7. Accounts scoring 50 to 79 show early decline or a single feature dropping off. They get an automated nudge while the CSM keeps watch.

PROOF OF CONCEPT

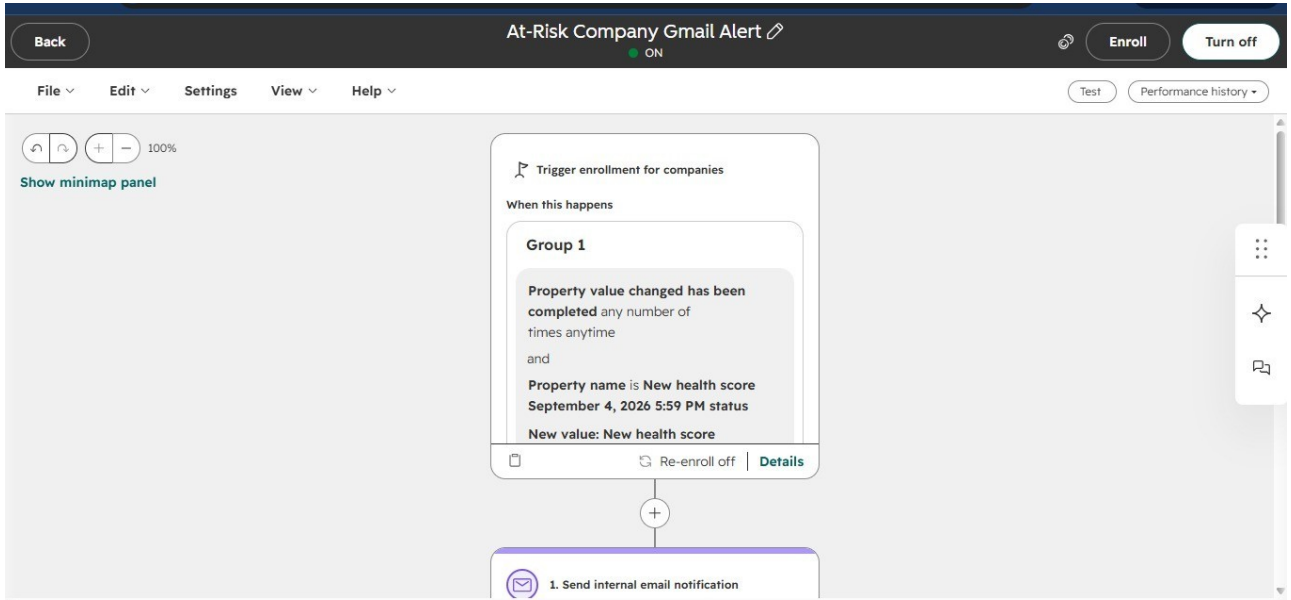
Health scores: at risk



Screenshot 4 of 7. Accounts below 50 are a live filter on the health score property, not a manual tag. It isolates 353 of 1,000 sample accounts, and these are the accounts the alert workflow acts on.

PROOF OF CONCEPT

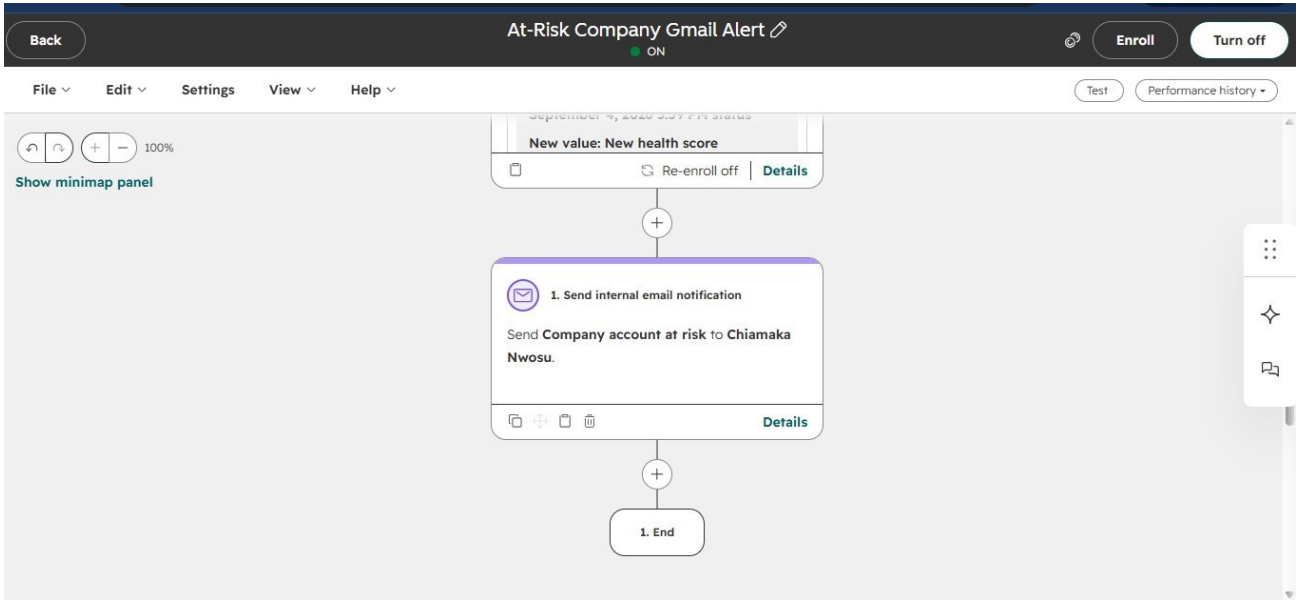
The alert workflow: trigger



Screenshot 5 of 7. The workflow enrols an account when its health score property changes and meets the at-risk condition.

PROOF OF CONCEPT

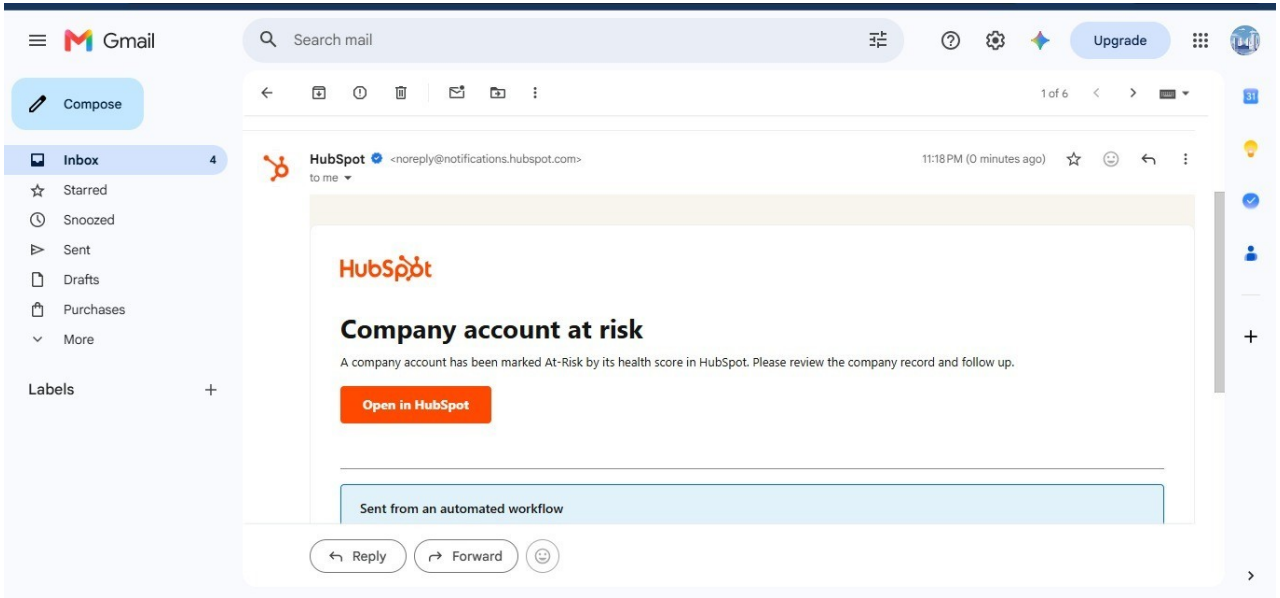
The alert workflow: notify the CSM



Screenshot 6 of 7. HubSpot sends an internal email notification to the assigned CSM, so no at-risk account depends on someone remembering to check.

PROOF OF CONCEPT

The alert arrives in the CSM's inbox



Screenshot 7 of 7. The alert lands in Gmail with a link to the company record. The CSM opens it and sees why the account was flagged, so the first conversation starts with the right question.

ROLES AND RISKS

Customer Success and Support, without a turf war

Customer Success

Proactive. Owns adoption, retention and growth. Acts on a health score drop, before any complaint.

Support

Reactive. Owns one bounded problem, such as a bug, and resolves it. Stays visible to the CSM.

Risks I planned for

A usage drop shows that something changed, not why, so every alert triggers a conversation. Too many alerts cause fatigue, so segmentation and ranking filter first.

TOOLS

Tool stack

HubSpot

The CRM: accounts, health scores, segments, the workflow and the alert.

Gmail

Where the automated at-risk alert lands for the CSM.

Excel

Structured and prepared the account and usage data before import.

Zendesk

Escalation path for technical and support issues.

Calendly & Zoom

Scheduling and hosting customer check-in calls.

Open to Customer Success work for B2B SaaS startups. Send me a message.